

Verifying BIS Hallmarks on Gold and Silver Jewellery · Consumer Guide (Sa

1. WHY VERIFY A HALLMARK

The BIS hallmark is the consumer's primary assurance that the fineness (purity) declared on a jewellery item was assayed by a BIS-recognised Assaying and Hallmarking Centre. Verification protects buyers from under-caratage and misdeclared purity. This guide is a training aid; official requirements are published by BIS.

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2. THE FIVE COMPONENTS OF A BIS HALLMARK

A full BIS hallmark on a jewellery item consists of: (1) the BIS standard mark (the BIS logo); (2) the fineness grade, for example 999 for 24K equivalent, 916 for 22K, 875 for 21K, 750 for 18K and 585 for 14K gold, and 925 for sterling silver; (3) the mark of the BIS-recognised Assaying and Hallmarking Centre; (4) the jeweller's or manufacturer's identification mark; and (5) the HUID - a six-digit alphanumeric unique identification code laser-marked on the item.

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3. STEP-BY-STEP CONSUMER VERIFICATION

Step 1: look for the BIS logo on the item. Step 2: read the fineness number and confirm it matches what the bill declares (916 means 22K). Step 3: locate the HUID six-character code. Step 4: open the official BIS Care mobile application or the BIS website verify facility, enter the HUID and confirm that the returned details (jeweller, centre, fineness) match the item. Step 5: check the purchase invoice mentions the hallmarking details. If any component is missing or the HUID does not verify, decline the purchase or demand an explanation from the jeweller.

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4. HALLMARKING CENTRES AND FINENESS RULES

Only BIS-recognised Assaying and Hallmarking Centres may apply the hallmark. The centres sample and assay jewellery lots to confirm the declared fineness before marking. Fineness grades in use for gold include 999, 916, 875, 750 and 585; for silver, common grades are 999, 958, 925, 900 and 800 as applicable under the relevant Indian Standards (IS 1417 for gold, IS 2112 for silver marking). The hallmarking of gold jewellery and artefacts has been made mandatory in phases through government orders; the current coverage and exemptions should be verified on the official BIS source.

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5. WHAT A HALLMARK DOES NOT GUARANTEE

The hallmark attests the fineness of the metal at the time of assaying. It is not a certificate for the weight of stones, the making charges, the design originality or the buy-back value offered by a jeweller. Consumers should also keep the invoice, because it links the item to the declared hallmark details. For disputes, BIS complaint channels and consumer forums are the appropriate escalation paths.